

Lenovo Legion 5i Pro

The Tesla Model 3 of gaming laptops



Christian Von Koenigsegg,
CEO of Koenigsegg Automotive AB, called the Tesla

Model 3 as the “best EV daily driver”. You must be wondering then that the Tesla Model 3 must be one really fast car, and objectively, it is. You must also think that the Tesla Model 3 must be the best-handling, the most feature loaded, or the most reliable car out there. Well, I am afraid, it isn't so either. What it really is is a very clever mixture of performance, design, and features that feel just right for the money you have to spend in order to own one. And in the same sense, the Lenovo Legion 5i Pro is also just like the Tesla Model 3 of the gaming laptop world.

By now you must have gotten an idea about where the new Lenovo Legion 5i Pro 2023 stands as a gaming laptop. But if you didn't get my reference, then here's what you need to know. The Lenovo Legion 5i Pro is a high-end gaming laptop that isn't exactly “super-premium” but delivers performance to easily play games at 1440p 60FPS and even higher in most cases. So what can we concur from this? Is the Lenovo Legion 5i Pro worth the price tag? To answer that question here's the Lenovo Legion 5i Pro (2023) review.

DESIGN AND BUILD QUALITY

The Lenovo Legion 5i Pro chassis uses plastic as well as metal. The lid cover is made up of CNC or Computer Numeric Control aluminium, in which metals, in this case, aluminium, are precisely cut with the help of machines. And the CNC process does not affect the strength of aluminium in any way and the lid does indeed feels very sturdy.

The rest of the laptop's chassis meanwhile, is made up of PC-ABS, which stands for polycarbonate (PC) and

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acrylonitrile butadiene styrene. These two

plastics combine resulting in a material that is strong and also heat resistant. The ABS part of the “PC-ABS” also helps prevent cracking or breaking in the laptop chassis.

My Legion 5i came in a greyish colour but obviously, Lenovo being a brand has

to call it something fancy. And it indeed does, my laptop's colour name is Onyx Grey. I think all the Pokémon fans just got hit with a wave of nostalgia. Nevertheless, it looks stealthy, with no RGB lights sticking out on its lid, and with a 22.45mm thickness and 2.55kg body weight, it is also decently portable.

Both sides of the chassis and the back of the laptop feature air vents and a wide variety of I/O ports. However, one small detail that impressed me a lot was the curved corners of the laptop. I mean, they're not excessively curved but curved enough to prevent discomfort in your wrist while typing.

I/O PORTS

In terms of connectivity, the Lenovo Legion 5 Pro earns impressive accolades.

A standout feature is its USB-C port, which boasts DisplayPort Alternate Mode and Power Delivery up to 140 watts. While this doesn't match the full power the laptop requires at maximum load, as it's supplied with a 300-watt power adapter, it's ample for less intensive tasks. This versatility allows users to leave the hefty 300-watt power adapter behind when the laptop's peak performance is not a necessity.

Complementing the primary USB-C port is another USB-C port, which supports DisplayPort but lacks Power Delivery, and three USB-A ports. The combined count of five USB ports is commendable for any laptop available in 2023. These are supplemented by an HDMI 2.1 port, an Ethernet port, and a 3.5mm combo audio jack. The strategic placement of most of these ports at the rear of the laptop enhances desk-based cable management.

On the wireless front, the Legion 5 Pro incorporates Wi-Fi 6E and Bluetooth 5.1, in line with the standards set by contemporary gaming laptops. The Wi-Fi performance proves to be quite robust when linked to a Wi-Fi 6 or Wi-Fi 6E router, negating the need for a wired Ethernet connection for many gamers, though it's available if required.

KEYBOARD

The Legion Pro 5i from Lenovo is a substantial piece of machinery that doesn't bring the tactile satisfaction of a mechanical keyboard to the table but still provides an unexpectedly comfortable and pleasing typing experience. Its keys function with a level of discretion that would appeal to noise-sensitive users, while still offering the personalization of a color-customizable keyboard, separated into four unique zones.

Lenovo has incorporated a full-size keyboard which means it has a dedicated number pad. Despite the numerical keys being somewhat less expansive compared to the standard keys, they offer a streamlined way to for using programs like Google Sheets, Excel, etc. As for the touchpad, Lenovo has opted

